

Out-of-home advertising: first market for a pedestrian comfort decision surface

aimez internal strategy note June 2026

The asset

We operate a measured decision surface for pedestrian movement in Manhattan: a street graph where every block carries validated layers for street pressure, tree canopy and surface heat, plus an engine that returns comparable routes with per-block statistics and confidence. Consumer routing is the demonstration. The durable product is the surface underneath, which knows where people walk and how exposed each block is.

Why out-of-home advertising is the first buyer

Out-of-home (OOH) advertising sells exposure: how many qualified people pass a billboard, transit shelter or storefront, and how long they linger. Foot-traffic exposure is the entire currency of the category. Three reasons it is the right first market:

- It buys a data product, not an app. We do not need a billion users; we need one exposure metric a media owner trusts.
- The incumbent measure is weak. Counts come from modeled mobile-location panels and static traffic estimates, with no model of why a block draws or repels foot traffic.
- Comfort predicts dwell. A shaded, low-pressure block holds pedestrians longer, which is exactly the impression quality an advertiser pays a premium for.

What we sell

A comfort-weighted exposure index per location: predicted pedestrian volume adjusted for how long people stay and how favorable the block is for attention, delivered with a confidence score and a per-block provenance trail. Media owners price inventory on it; brands buy placements against it.

Wedge against incumbents

Geopath, StreetMetrics and panel vendors report counts and impressions from mobile-location data. None of them models the physical conditions that govern whether a pedestrian slows down, looks up or hurries past. Our surface adds the explanatory layer they lack, and the validation discipline behind it is the barrier to entry, since a competitor cannot copy it by re-weighting public counts.

First pilot

One corridor, one metric, one buyer. Pick a high-inventory midtown stretch, produce a comfort-weighted exposure index for each panel location, and compare it against the media owner's existing impression numbers on the same blocks. The deliverable is a single ranked table plus maps. Success is the owner agreeing the index reorders their inventory in a way their current data missed.

Pricing

Start as a paid pilot study, then a per-market annual data license keyed to inventory count. Land with one media owner, expand to brand-side media buyers who want independent exposure quality before committing spend.

Honest risks

- OOH measurement is a standards-driven category; an independent index has to be benchmarked against accepted methods before owners adopt it.
- Comfort-to-dwell is a hypothesis, not a measured fact yet; the pilot has to show the link before the premium claim holds.
- Mobile-location panels have scale we do not; our advantage is the explanatory layer and validation, not raw coverage, so the pitch stays on quality, not volume.